NATIONAL MEANS-CUM-MERIT SCHOLARSHIP SCHEME (NMMSS)

1. SCHEME PURPOSE AND OBJECTIVE
The National Means-cum-Merit Scholarship Scheme (NMMSS) is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme launched by the Ministry of Education, Government of India.
Its main objective is to award scholarships to meritorious students of economically weaker sections to arrest dropouts after Class VIII and motivate them to continue secondary education up to senior secondary stage (Classes IX to XII).

2. SCHOLARSHIP AMOUNT AND DISBURSEMENT
- Scholarship Amount: Rs. 12,000/- (Rupees Twelve Thousand only) per annum per student (equivalent to Rs. 1,000/- per month).
- Duration: Awarded for a maximum duration of 4 years from Class IX to Class XII.
- Payment Mechanism: 100% scholarship funds are disbursed directly into the student's Aadhaar-linked savings bank account through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) via the Public Financial Management System (PFMS).
- A total quota of 1,00,000 new scholarships is allocated annually across all States and Union Territories based on student enrollment in Class VII and VIII.

NMMSS: ELIGIBILITY CONDITIONS & INELIGIBILITY

3. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA FOR APPLICATION
A student must fulfill all of the following criteria to be eligible for NMMSS:
- Student Category: Must be enrolled as a regular student in Class VIII in a Government school, Government-aided school, or Local Body school.
- Minimum Marks in Class VII: Must have scored at least 55% marks or equivalent grade in the Class VII annual examination (relaxed to 50% for SC and ST students).
- Parental Income Limit: The total annual parental/guardian income from all sources must not exceed Rs. 3,50,000/- (Rupees Three Lakh Fifty Thousand only). Valid income certificate issued by a competent state authority is mandatory.

4. INELIGIBLE INSTITUTIONS (STRICT EXCLUSIONS)
The following categories of students are NOT eligible to appear or receive scholarships under NMMSS:
- Students studying in Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas (JNVs).
- Students studying in Kendriya Vidyalayas (KVs).
- Students studying in private un-aided schools.
- Students studying in residential schools run by Central/State Governments where boarding, lodging, and education are free of cost (e.g., Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas, Sainik Schools, Eklavya Model Residential Schools).

NMMSS: SELECTION PROCESS, RENEWAL & PORTAL

5. SELECTION EXAMINATION
Each State/UT conducts a competitive written examination for Class VIII students comprising two tests:
- Test 1: Mental Ability Test (MAT) - 90 multiple choice questions on reasoning, analogy, classification, and numerical series.
- Test 2: Scholastic Aptitude Test (SAT) - 90 multiple choice questions covering science, mathematics, and social studies of Class VII & VIII syllabus.
- Qualifying Marks: At least 40% aggregate marks in MAT + SAT combined (relaxed to 32% for SC/ST students).

6. SCHOLARSHIP RENEWAL CRITERIA
To continue receiving the scholarship in Classes X, XI, and XII:
- Must pass Class IX and Class XI in the first attempt with at least 55% marks (50% for SC/ST).
- Must obtain at least 60% marks in Class X board examination (55% for SC/ST) to continue receiving the scholarship in Class XI and XII.

7. APPLICATION ON NATIONAL SCHOLARSHIP PORTAL (NSP)
- Selected students must apply online on the National Scholarship Portal (NSP) at scholarships.gov.in.
- Mandatory Documents: Class VII/VIII mark sheet, Income Certificate, Caste Certificate (if applicable), Aadhaar Card, and Bank Passbook copy seeded with Aadhaar.